continued to tell them I wasn't a candidate and didn't want it. But they'd just go away and say I *was* a candidate.

Former Senator William F. Knowland came to me one day when all of this was going on and said he wanted to let me know that the California delegation were planning to issue a unanimous statement declaring that, in their minds, I should be considered a bonafide candidate for the nomination.

"Damn it, Bill," I said, "you know it's not true. I'm going to have to repudiate them if they do that." He said, "We know that, Ron, but there's so much sentiment for you we think you'll end up as a laughing-stock if somebody doesn't say we are taking you as a serious candidate."

Well, when the balloting took place, I got a sizable number of votes behind Nixon and Rockefeller, but Nixon had the clear majority and so I ran up to the front of the hall and jumped on the platform and asked the chairman for permission to address the convention.

At first, I was turned down because of a procedural rule, but after a minute they agreed to waive the rule and let me speak and I made a motion that the delegates nominate Richard Nixon by acclamation and they did so with a tremendous roar.

Afterward, Rockefeller told me, "You didn't get as many votes as we counted on; we thought you'd stop Nixon for us." I guess he thought I'd take enough votes away from Nixon to give him the nomination on a split.

The next day, Nancy and I left on a restful trip through the Florida Keys aboard a friend's yacht—only the two of us and the crew.

That first night, we slept fourteen hours, and we felt the greatest sense of relief either of us had ever known.

Because I consented to be a favorite-son candidate that year, some people have suggested that I was bitten by the presidential "bug" back in 1968. But it wasn't true. When